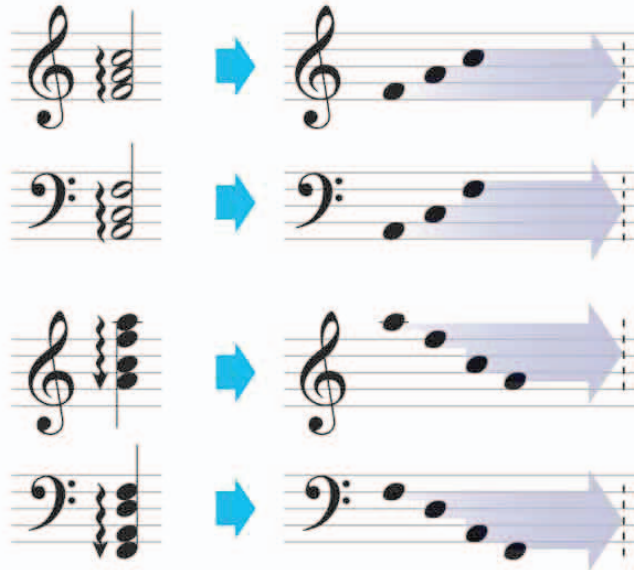


Sustaining sounds

Sometimes composers want a more sustained or continuous sound, especially in underlying harmonic parts of a melody. Two typical ways to accomplish this are by using broken chords and, on the piano, the sustaining, or damper, pedal. For an arpeggio sound—notes of a chord played in succession—a wavy line symbol is written beside a chord. This means that rather than playing the entire chord at once, the performer plays each tone one at a time, spreading out the harmony across a longer time in a strumming effect.



86

◁ Arpeggiated chord (upward)

In this example, each note in the chord will be played from the bottom up, timing the three notes to sound across the two beats of the notated half note.

87

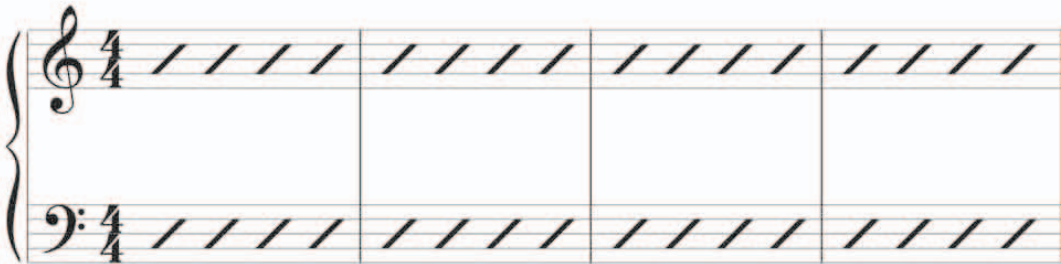
◁ Arpeggiated chord (downward)

These chords are played similarly—one pitch at a time—but starting at the top note and playing them consecutively a bit faster: timing the four notes to sound across one beat.

Piano pedals

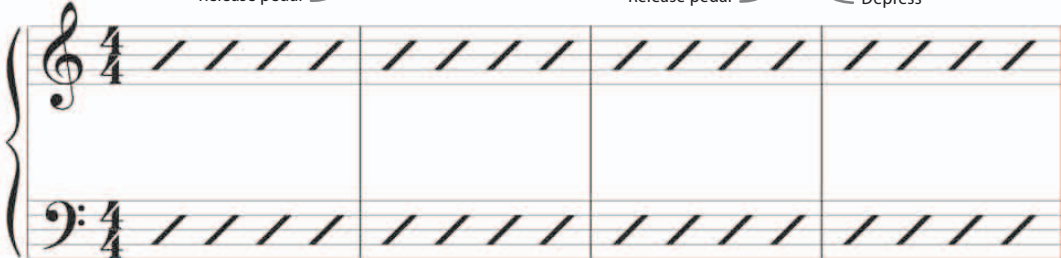
On the piano, sustaining tones with the damper pedal is a crucial way to maintain pitches for longer than they would normally last before fading. Pedal marks are notated with a scripted, stylized *Ped.*, or a bracket indicating depress and release times.

The **sustaining/damper pedal** lifts all the dampers on the strings so they keep **vibrating** long after the key is struck on the keyboard.



◁ Brackets

Brackets indicate where performers press down the damper pedal to sustain the notes within it—lifting and lowering the pedal with the V-shaped marks between the lines.



◁ Scripted mark

The italicized, scripted abbreviation *Ped.* is sometimes used instead of the bracket. It means the performer should hold down the pedal until the asterisk—indicating release.

